efforts to establish information-sharing agreements with other IOs. To test this, we first analyzed trends in the number of such agreements over time. We then examined evidence of information suppression during Trump's tenure, finding a simultaneous rise in formal information-sharing agreements and a decline in the provision of accurate data by the United States. While causality cannot be firmly established, the evidence aligns with our theoretical expectations.

The number of information-sharing agreements signed by US-led development IOs, such as the World Bank, Inter-American Development Bank, and others, surged dramatically after Trump's election in 2016. As shown in figure 4.4, 2017 marked a significant increase in these agreements compared with those of prior years. This uptick is not merely a byproduct of new opportunities presented by recently established IOs, such as the New Development Bank and the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank. Instead, US-led IOs also actively sought cooperation with long-standing institutions like the Arab Coordination Group, which includes IOs specializing in energy and infrastructure.